Palbociclib with endocrine therapy

Take palbociclib for 21 days, then have 7 days without palbociclib. The aromatase-inhibitor tablet continues every day, or fulvestrant injections follow their separate schedule. The week off applies to palbociclib, not automatically to the hormone treatment.

Make treatment fit into daily life

Check whether the pharmacy supplied capsules or tablets: capsules are taken with food; tablets can be taken with or without food. Swallow whole at a consistent time. Avoid grapefruit. If you miss or vomit a dose, do not take an extra dose; take the next scheduled dose. Do not restart after a clinical hold until the treating team confirms.

Two treatments with different clocks

An aromatase inhibitor is taken continuously. If fulvestrant is the partner, the usual 500 mg injection schedule is Days 1, 15 and 29 initially, then every 28 days under NCCP scheduling. Injection dose and tolerability need their own clinical review. Ovarian-suppression injections, if needed, have another prescribed schedule.

The first two cycles need an extra blood test

The Day 15 blood count checks for early marrow suppression. A Day 22 repeat may be requested after a low Day 15 count. The team interprets the result and tells you whether to continue or pause.

The week off and next prescription

Days 22–28 are the planned palbociclib rest week. Arrange the next blood test and supply in advance. The team may draw pre-cycle bloods locally before Day 1; the exact appointment is a local arrangement, not a universal Day 25/26 rule.

New medicines and formulations

Tell the oncology pharmacist about antibiotics, antifungals, supplements and herbal medicines. Avoid St John’s Wort and grapefruit. Food instructions differ for capsules and tablets, so check the dispensed box.

Visits and access

Palbociclib itself is an oral treatment and does not require a port or infusion pump. Fulvestrant or ovarian-suppression partners require injection visits. Do not infer that these visits stop during the palbociclib rest week.

Who arranges each check?

Agree the due window, booking team, result reviewer and whom to contact if an appointment or result is missing. This reference page does not book or record a test.

Sources and review

The NCCP regimen supplies the treatment rules. Separate guidelines supply the longer-term monitoring recommendations, with their qualifications retained.

- NCCP 00414 Palbociclib Therapy–28 day, version 5 a, 11 August 2026, pp 1–5
- EMA Ibrance SmPC / patient leaflet; product information updated 7 March 2025, sections 4.1–4.8 and 5.1
- Pan-Asian adapted ESMO early breast cancer guidelines
- Pan-Asian adapted ESMO metastatic breast cancer guidelines
- ESO-ESMO ABC 5 consensus: tumour-marker interpretation
- PALOMA-2, palbociclib + letrozole: EMA efficacy tables 6 and 8
- PALOMA-3, palbociclib + fulvestrant: EMA efficacy table 9

Source-reconciled development content; independent oncology, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending